



# Academic Integrity and Generative Artificial Intelligence – Views and Perceptions of Students in an Irish University

Violeta Morari<sup>1</sup> · D. Grimes<sup>2</sup> · D. Hawe<sup>1</sup>

Received: 30 June 2025 / Accepted: 7 October 2025 / Published online: 29 October 2025  
© The Author(s), under exclusive licence to Springer Nature B.V. 2025

## Abstract

The development of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) tools like ChatGPT have transformed the academic landscape, offering learning opportunities while raising significant challenges regarding academic integrity. This study explores student perceptions and behaviours concerning academic integrity and the use of GenAI in the context of an Irish University, specifically MTU. It draws insights from a comprehensive survey of 608 students across various faculties and academic stages. Key findings reveal diverse views on the ethical use of GenAI, gaps in awareness of institutional integrity policies and a preference for institutional mechanisms to report misconduct while highlighting unwillingness to report it directly. The research highlights uncertainty regarding GenAI use among students, a pressing need for clear policy guidance, targeted integrity education, and structured support for ethical engagement with GenAI in higher education.

**Keywords** Generative artificial intelligence · Academic integrity · Student perceptions · Student survey

## Introduction

The development of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) tools such as ChatGPT has transformed higher education, presenting opportunities to enhance student learning while raising concerns about academic integrity. These tools are capable of generating human-like text and performing complex problem-solving, challenge traditional notions of originality

---

✉ Violeta Morari  
Violeta.Morari@MTU.ie

D. Grimes  
Diarmuid.Grimes@MTU.ie

D. Hawe  
David.Hawe@MTU.ie

<sup>1</sup> Department of Mathematics, MTU, Cork, Ireland

<sup>2</sup> Department of Computer Science, MTU, Cork, Ireland

and authorship in academic work. Recent studies underscore the dual impact of GenAI, highlighting its potential to aid student understanding and productivity while posing significant risks of misuse, such as undetectable plagiarism and over-reliance on AI-generated solutions. As observed in other literature reviews, e.g. (Johnston et al., 2024), there are limited studies surrounding GenAI technologies, how universities should respond to continued rapid development of GenAI and its impact on academic integrity.

In response to concerns about academic integrity, MTU conducted a comprehensive survey, targeting students from diverse faculties and academic stages. This survey aimed to explore students' familiarity with academic integrity policies, their perceptions of misconduct, and their use of GenAI tools. This work is an initial exploratory analysis of the data generated and further modelling with these data will be the subject of future work. With over 600 respondents, the survey provided an opportunity to gain an understanding of student attitudes and behaviours, offering critical insights into the challenges faced by higher education institutions in addressing integrity in the digital age. These findings form the basis for this study, which examines relationships between student demographics, academic integrity awareness, and perceptions of GenAI.

Building on these findings, this paper investigates the challenges and opportunities posed by GenAI in higher education. By examining how students perceive and use these tools, it aims to inform institutional policies and pedagogical strategies to uphold integrity while embracing technological advancements.

This paper will also present findings on the possible connections and relationships between students' field of study, age and programme stage, and their perceptions of academic integrity and misconduct. Specifically, we examine respondents' self-reported knowledge of MTU's integrity policies, their awareness of both personal and peer breaches of integrity, and their personal views on academic integrity.

## Literature Review

Academic Integrity has been defined in Ireland's National Principles and Lexicon of Common Terms (2021, p.3) as "the commitment to, and demonstration of, honest and moral behaviour in an academic setting". The problem of cheating and academic misconduct in higher education is certainly not a new one. There are decades of studies, surveys and analysis done in various countries which grapple with the problem. Research on academic cheating dates from the turn of the twentieth century with the earliest studies having been conducted in the fields of education and educational psychology (Campbell, 1933; Harts-horne et al., 1929).

Traditionally, a large portion of studies around academic misconduct was focused on essay mills and sharing websites, as well as plagiarism, fabrication and falsification of data. Because academic misconduct can be hard to measure accurately, most researchers rely on self-declaration obtained from surveys and focus groups. In her New York Times article, Zernike (2002) quoted the Center for Academic Integrity's (CAI) statistics: a total of 27% of students questioned during the 2001–2002 academic year said that falsifying laboratory data happened "often or very often" on campus. Also, 41% of students admitted engaging in plagiarism on written assignments, 30% for cheating during tests or exams, and 60% in collaborating on work when a professor has instructed students to work alone.

A later study with almost 15,000 responses, conducted across 11 Canadian higher education institutions (Hughes & McCabe, 2006) found that cheating was a significant issue with students citing external perceptions of misconduct, faculty practices, low perceived risks, unclear policies, lack of integrity education, peer behaviour and external pressures as main reasons for academic misconduct. Cheating was found to be more common in men, less able students, younger students, and science and technology students, with motivation playing a major role in these differences (Newstead et al., 1996).

Of course, students' perceptions can vary significantly, and they can be discipline specific. For example, an Australian study (Simon & Sheard, 2015) found that a notable percentage of students (15%) think that copying in certain types of assessments, like programming or mathematics, can be legitimate if students contribute to the work and might go undetected because of answer similarity.

Also, the influence of peers can be a significant predictor of students' intentions to cheat (Teodorescu, 2009). In this study ( $n=1025$ ), students who reported a high incidence of cheating among their peers were found more likely to engage in cheating themselves.

Another reason for academic dishonesty can be ignorance about what constitutes dishonest behaviour. For example, one of the main findings of the quantitative results in an Australian University (Busch & Bilgin, 2014) was the disconnect between academic staff and students' beliefs about academic honesty and the reactions of students and academics to dishonest behaviour. The same study found the unwillingness of students to report their peers for academic dishonesty, specifically cheating – which, is consistent with our findings, indicating potentially, a more general trend.

In more recent times, GenAI has put significant pressure on established assessment practices in tertiary education. Educators' reluctance may also undermine the full realisation of AI's capacity to promote independent learning and problem-solving skills (Haroud & Saqri, 2025). The uneven levels of encouragement from teaching staff can therefore influence how effectively students incorporate GenAI into their academic work. Beyond cultural differences, the literature points to structural issues related to ethics and policy. The integration of GenAI technologies into higher education has prompted calls for guidelines that address misuse and safeguard academic integrity. Concerns here extend beyond traditional definitions of misconduct to include new forms such as producing AI-generated text without acknowledgment, coined by some researchers as AI-giarism (Taiye et al., 2024). GenAI is changing the landscape of teaching and assessment and rethinking is required on how and what is assessed; how to ensure students' work is their own; how to promote learning through the use of Gen AI; how to build appropriate digital literacies through assessment; and how to build human capabilities for working in an GenAI-mediated world (Lodge et al., 2023). GenAI tools can enhance academic integrity but must be used ethically and with caution (Panukhnyk, 2023). These tools can either help in a scientific environment or promote deception, plagiarism, and manipulation.

When considering factors that influence learners' views of the ethics associated with GenAI, the stage learners are at in their studies was identified as important in shaping their views on academic integrity. GenAI tools are already being embedded within other applications such as word processing software or slideware. Therefore, GenAI in higher education requires rethinking and research to address key areas impacted by such large language models and applications (Lodge et al., 2023).

We also note that the impact on students can be quite different, depending on a lot of factors such as gender, discipline etc. For example, international students, who may already face biases and discrimination, could be disproportionately impacted by reliance on AI detection tools (Farrelly & Baker, 2023; Yu & Guo, 2023). This can indicate that there is a need for careful implementation and support to ensure these technologies are accessible, applied with equality, and beneficial for all students, regardless of their background or location. Students also tend to use GenAI in different ways and moreover, trust in GenAI among students is influenced by factors such as discipline and academic background (Amoozadeh et al., 2023).

On the other hand, pitfalls of GenAI have also been noted: plagiarism, overreliance, misinformation, and privacy concerns (Qadir, 2023). Consequences can also extend to the spreading of mis- and disinformation, perpetuation of discrimination, distortion of public discourse and markets, and even incitement of violence (Lorenz et al., 2023). It also poses ethical risks such as data security, deconstructing teacher-student roles, and educational inequality (Bu, 2022). GenAI in craft education can inspire creativity but concerns around generated images and copyright violations have also been noted in a number of studies (Vartiainen & Tedre, 2023). However, much of the current discourse on ChatGPT in education is driven by media and lacks substantial input from students (Kelly et al., 2023).

Cheating during online exams remains a significant challenge, with 44.7% of students self-reporting instances of academic dishonesty, as highlighted by Newton and Essex (2024). Among these cases, individual acts of cheating were more prevalent than collaborative efforts, underscoring the ease with which students can exploit online settings without external accountability. This trend raises critical concerns about the effectiveness of current assessment methods and the importance of ensuring transparency in online evaluation practices. Hill and Narine (2023) emphasise the necessity for educational institutions to adopt robust measures that promote integrity, such as secure technology platforms, employing proctoring solutions, and fostering a culture of trust and accountability among students.

As GenAI becomes increasingly embedded in academic contexts, its impact on teaching, research, and administration warrants closer examination, as highlighted by Barros et al. (2023). Yet, recent research has raised ethical questions around GenAI's role in education. For example, a recent study noted the social justice implications of students using GenAI to generate non-original work and faculty employing detection tools (Healy, 2023). Conversely, Kelly et al. (2023) suggest that GenAI may foster academic success, particularly among underrepresented student groups. GenAI thus holds the potential to enhance equality within academic and research integrity, though Bearman et al. (2024) stress the importance of equipping students with critical skills to assess GenAI-produced content. Evidence from student surveys indicates a split perception: while nearly half believe GenAI aids critical thinking and problem-solving, substantial proportions remain neutral or unconvinced about its transformative impact (Sousa & Cardoso, 2025).

Given this emerging focus, our study aims to contribute to the understanding of students' perspectives on academic integrity, misconduct, and the role of GenAI. By examining these attitudes, we hope to inform meaningful policy and pedagogical responses. Recent studies at the University of Liverpool, found that 54.1% of students supported tools like Grammarly, while 70.4% expressed ambivalence about generative tools like ChatGPT (Johnston et al., 2024). In Sweden, Malmström et al. (2023) surveyed nearly 6,000 students, who largely viewed GenAI as positively impacting their learning.

The recent HEPI Reports found that the student use of AI has increased significantly during the 2025 year, with almost all students (92%) using AI in some form in 2025, up from 66% in 2024, and some 88% having used GenAI for assessments, up from 53% in 2024 (Freeman, 2025, 2024). The survey also found that the main uses of GenAI was for explaining concepts, summarising articles and suggesting research ideas, but a significant number of students have included AI-generated text directly in their work.

Building on these findings, the second part of our survey explores students' attitudes towards GenAI and its potential links to academic misconduct.

## Methods

### Research Questions

There are several questions that have been considered as part of this work. These questions have informed the design of the survey and the analysis thereof. These questions were:

- How do students at MTU perceive and use Generative AI tools in academic settings?
- What factors influence whether they view the use of Generative AI as ethical or inappropriate?
- What types of academic misconduct are most commonly self-reported by students, and how do students view the value of a reporting tool for academic integrity breaches?

### Design and Deployment of the Survey

In 2023, in response to growing concerns across the higher education sector about academic integrity, a group of MTU staff launched a project titled “Academic Integrity: Supporting Staff-Student Courageous Conversations.” The study followed a mixed approach, combining a university-wide online survey with qualitative student focus groups.

A foundational step in this project was understanding students' perceptions of academic integrity, misconduct, and their familiarity with, and use of, GenAI tools. To this end, a survey was designed and distributed to specific student cohorts at MTU. Following historical approaches in academic integrity research, such as (Bowers, 1964), the survey gathered demographic information to explore the influences shaping students' beliefs and behaviours regarding academic integrity. Similar to studies by McCabe (2005) and Hughes and McCabe (2006), this survey covered a wide scope of integrity-related behaviours, driven by the research questions listed above examining multiple forms of academic misconduct. This 22-question survey was designed by the authors drawing on the current and past research (Malmström et al., 2023).

To establish content validity, the draft survey was reviewed by a number of staff from the Teaching and Learning Unit (TLU) as well as academic staff with interests in academic integrity, AI and digital education. Panel members were asked to assess each item for relevance, clarity, and alignment with the study's objectives. Based on their feedback, several questions were revised for clarity, and new items were added to address gaps in the original version.

The survey was deployed online during the first Semester of the academic year 2023–2024. Its purpose was to establish students' opinions of and familiarity with, academic integrity, particularly with respect to the emergence of recent GenAI tools. This was to gain an insight into students' perceptions and use of Generative AI and allowed a rich dataset to be generated on this topic for analysis.

The survey team contacted heads of departments to share the survey with all students. This was done with a view to getting as large a response as possible. This is a non-probabilistic method known as volunteer sampling which does present certain limitations but also has benefits including being practical and cost effective. Participants were recruited from the student population of MTU and targeted students from all ranges of academic disciplines and stages. This allowed several areas to be considered in terms of the key research questions, where key factors can be ascertained from the survey data in terms of which groups are exhibiting different behaviours. Prior permission to contact students was obtained from the Office of the Registrar. The survey was disseminated via institutional email and hosted on Microsoft Forms. The response from various groups was not uniform and while a relatively strong response was received from learners in two faculties of the largest campus, others did not respond in such strong numbers. This is partly due to different levels of encouragement and stimuli across departments e.g. some departments reminded and encouraged students to submit to the survey a number of times or gave learners a chance to complete the survey in class time while others may not have been as proactive. This will be discussed later and is called out as a limitation on the ability to make inference on the entire population of students at the university.

Before proceeding, participants were presented with an informed consent statement. The first question in the survey served as a mandatory consent checkpoint: participants who selected "no" were automatically exited from the survey. Only participants who gave explicit consent could continue. Survey participation was entirely voluntary and anonymous, with no identifying information collected.

A pilot version of the survey was distributed to a small group of students ( $n=15$ ) who were not part of the main study sample. This phase aimed to identify:

- Ambiguities in question wording,
- Technical or formatting issues within the Microsoft Forms platform,
- Question redundancy, and,
- Estimated completion time.

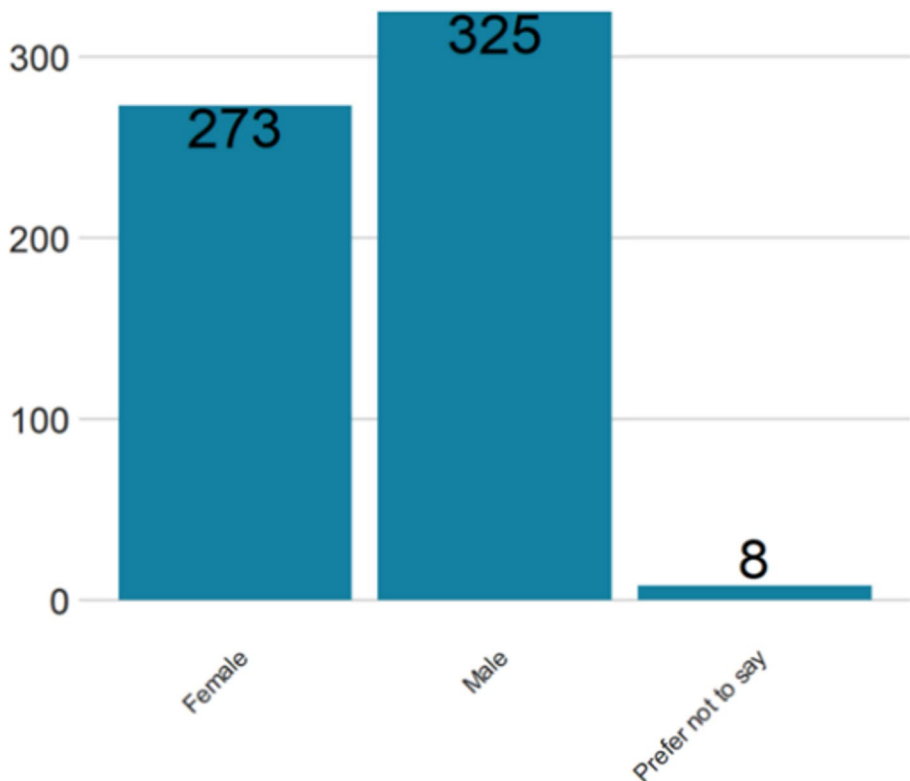
Minor modifications were made following pilot testing to enhance the instrument's usability and flow. Pilot responses were not included in the final analysis.

Overall, the survey was split into three sections: the first section recorded demographic information from the students, the second section recorded general information regarding familiarity with, and experience of, academic integrity, while the third section focused on GenAI and other AI tools including the value learners see in a reporting tool for inappropriate behaviour. These areas are aligned with the research questions listed above. The survey was anonymous, conducted online and contained a variety of questions (both quantitative and qualitative). It consisted of a combination of open and closed-ended questions. The survey had two mandatory questions regarding consent and age. All the other questions were voluntary. As there are a large number of items that can be considered under the banner of

academic integrity and generative AI, learners were asked over fifty questions. This paper discusses a subset of these.

The overall population of MTU (approximately 14,345 students) were of interest as part of this work (more details about the overall population of MTU, including gender, stages etc. is available in the Economic and Social Impact Study of MTU, 2024).

MTU is composed of two faculties and three schools, namely: Faculty of Engineering and Science, Faculty of Business and Humanities, School of Health and Social Science, School of Business, Computing & Humanities and School of Science, Technology, Engineering & Mathematics. The survey, conducted in MTU, gathered responses from 608 students, representing diverse faculties and academic stages. A balanced gender distribution was observed, with 325 males and 273 females participating, and a further ten students not revealing their gender (Fig. 1). Most respondents (547 out of 608) were from the faculties of Business and Humanities (FBH) and the Faculty of Engineering and Science (FES) on the Cork Campuses and with the remaining responses from the Kerry Campuses. Specific information such as age, study area, stage of award, gender, and competence in English were sought. Related information was then recorded regarding each student's familiarity with academic integrity, associated MTU policies and supports provided around assessment literacy. Finally, this related information was analysed from the perspective of study area to determine any associations and correlations. In total, in the FBH, 2017 students were



**Fig. 1** Gender breakdown of survey participants

invited to complete the survey, giving a response rate of 14.03% (mapping to a margin of error of 5.39% at a 95% level of confidence). In the FES we had a total of 1974 and 263 responses, giving a similar response rate of 13.32% (margin of error of 5.63% at a 95% level of confidence).

A detailed breakdown of student cohorts is given in Table 1: It is necessary to highlight that a limitation to the analysis is driven by a particularly low response rate outside of the two faculties on the Cork Campuses. Accordingly, valuable inference based on this survey is limited to these two faculties. Ideally, a strong response rate from all cohorts would have been achieved but as this is not the case conclusions made in this work should be considered in this context. The survey was sent to students in the two faculties on Cork Campuses and the three schools on the Kerry campuses. There is also a potential bias in the gathered dataset due to the nonresponse from many of those asked to participate. It is not possible to say with certainty that the views of those willing to participate in the survey are not going to be different to those who do not participate and any impact of this bias cannot be readily quantified.

## Findings and Analysis

In terms of the analysis that follows, proportions of data from the sample size are presented and in some cases the percentages are extrapolated to the population. Limitations exist around non-response bias and the non probabilistic sampling on such extrapolations. Since the response was strongest in the two faculties Cork campuses, generalisations should be considered in the context of these faculties only. It may be the case that other groups behave in a similar fashion to those with a high response rate but that cannot be asserted without questionable assumptions.

In line with considerations around the perception and use and factors that affect the view of GenAI, there are some key findings of interest. For example, only 43% (SE 2%) of students reported familiarity with institutional academic integrity policies, highlighting a significant gap in awareness. Lecturers emerged as the primary information source, cited by 207 students, followed by course coordinators (174) and the university website (125).

**Table 1** Breakdown of survey participants including gender breakdown male (M), female (F), other (O)

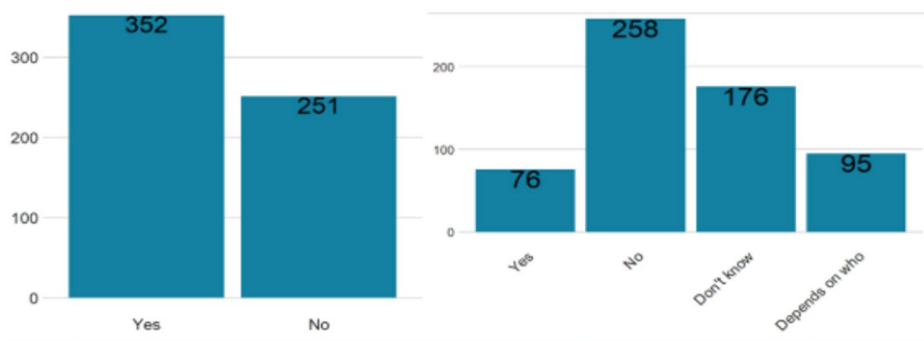
|              | Faculty of Business<br>& Humanities (Cork) | Faculty of Engineer-<br>ing & Science (Cork) | School of Health<br>& Social Science<br>(Kerry) | Other            | Total      |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------|------------|
| 1st Year     | 126<br>(58 M 68 F)                         | 99<br>(66 M 32 F 10 O)                       | 0<br>(0 M 0 F)                                  | 17<br>(4 M 13 F) | <b>242</b> |
| 2nd Year     | 55<br>(36 M 17 F 2 O)                      | 67<br>(40 M 24 F 3 O)                        | 14<br>(4 M 10 F)                                | 8<br>(4 M 4 F)   | <b>144</b> |
| 3rd Year     | 36<br>(13 M 22 F 1 O)                      | 42<br>(28 M 13 F 1 O)                        | 2<br>(1 M 1 F)                                  | 6<br>(4 M 2 F)   | <b>86</b>  |
| 4th Year     | 59<br>(25 M 34 F)                          | 29<br>(9 M 18 F 2 O)                         | 3<br>(2 M 1 F)                                  | 4<br>(2 M 2 F)   | <b>95</b>  |
| Graduate     | 6<br>(4 M 2 F)                             | 23<br>(17 M 6 F)                             | 0<br>(M F)                                      | 2<br>(2 M)       | <b>31</b>  |
| Other        | 1<br>(1 F)                                 | 3<br>(2 M 1 F)                               | 0<br>(M F)                                      | 1<br>(1 M)       | <b>5</b>   |
| <b>Total</b> | <b>283</b>                                 | <b>263</b>                                   | <b>19</b>                                       | <b>38</b>        | <b>603</b> |

In a lot of questions in this survey, students selected the “neutral” option on the Likert scale. When survey respondents most frequently selected the neutral option, this pattern may suggest a variety of things such as ambivalence, uncertainty or lack of strong feelings toward the statement. A strong or dominant neutral response can also indicate that students have insufficient knowledge or experience to form a clear opinion, particularly in areas where institutional policies or practices are not well communicated. Alternatively, neutrality may reflect a tendency toward social desirability bias, where respondents prefer not to commit to a positive or negative stance. In the context of academic integrity and GenAI, a high proportion of neutral responses could also signal that students are still developing their understanding of these emerging issues, or that they perceive the matter as complex, making it difficult to categorically agree or disagree. This outcome highlights the need for further awareness-raising, training, or clarification of policies to move students from passive neutrality toward more informed and engaged positions.

The first case in point is the use of GenAI. Regarding the use of GenAI, 43.9% (SE 2%) of students agreed that its use for assignments constitutes cheating, while 32% (SE 1.9%) expressed neutrality. Acceptance of GenAI increased with academic stage, with fourth-year students showing the most significant shift in perspective. Interestingly, 22.1% (SE 1.7) of students agreed that GenAI enhances learning efficacy, though many remained neutral.

Another area of interest was to explore students’ views on reporting academic misconduct. Notably, while only 28% (SE 1.8%) of students stated that they would report peer misconduct, 58% (SE 2%) supported the introduction of a reporting tool, indicating a preference for institutional accountability mechanisms. This could be explained by a cultural reluctance in Ireland to report a peer. Faculty comparisons revealed significant differences in the discussion of GenAI, with FES lecturers emphasising the topic more frequently than their FBH counterparts.

The graphs presented below in Fig. 2 highlight students’ perspectives on reporting academic dishonesty in line with the third research question and the potential implementation of a reporting tool. The first graph explores attitudes toward the creation of a formal reporting tool, where support (352 respondents) outweighs opposition (251 respondents), showing a notable divide in student opinion on an academic misconduct tool. In contrast, the second graph examines whether students would report a peer for cheating, revealing a predominant reluctance, as the majority (258 respondents) indicated they would not, with smaller groups expressing uncertainty (176) or conditional willingness (95). Interestingly though,



**Fig. 2** a Should there be a student reporting tool for academic integrity? b Would you report a fellow student?

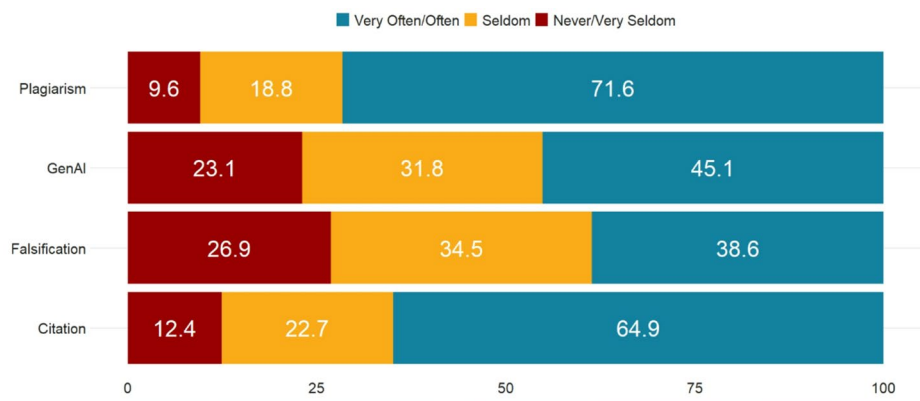
most students would like a reporting tool, which may suggest that as a principle, a student will consider reporting another student for cheating if this is viewed as an unfair advantage.

## Discussion of Types of Academic Misconduct in Class

The importance of academic misconduct discussions in class is critical to understanding students use of Generative AI and factors that affect the use of same. The survey results (see Fig. 3 below) highlight that most lecturers still focus on more traditional topics of academic integrity, particularly plagiarism and proper citation. Among respondents, 423 (71.6% SE 1.8%) indicated that plagiarism was discussed “Very Often/Often,” while 387 (64.9% SE 1.9%) noted the same for proper citation. This perhaps reflects that staff are more comfortable discussing what used to be the “classic” misconducts.

One interesting finding from the survey is the infrequent discussion of GenAI tools, such as ChatGPT and other chatbots. Only 137 respondents (23.1% SE 1.71%) indicated that these tools were discussed “Very Often/Often,” while 189 (31.2% SE 1.9) reported “Seldom,” and a significant 268 (45.1% SE 2.0) noted “Never/Very Seldom.” This distribution reveals a considerable gap in addressing the ethical implications and proper usage of GenAI technologies in academic contexts. As GenAI tools become more integrated into learning and research, the lack of structured conversations around their ethical use may leave students underprepared to navigate these emerging challenges. Institutions need to address this gap by incorporating discussions about GenAI technologies into academic integrity frameworks, ensuring students understand both their potential and their ethical implications.

Discussions surrounding data fabrication and falsification also appear to be limited. While 160 respondents (26.9% SE 1.8%) indicated that this topic was discussed “Very Often/Often,” a larger number—205 (34.5% SE 1.9%)—reported “Seldom,” and 229 (38.6% SE 2%) said “Never/Very Seldom.” This lack of consistent engagement is concerning, especially in disciplines where research and data analysis play a central role. If students are not adequately informed about the ethical handling of data, they may be ill-equipped to uphold research integrity. Given the critical role of trustworthy data in maintaining the credibility of academic work, institutions should increase the emphasis on this topic in both classroom discussions and academic policies.



**Fig. 3** How often did your lecturers discuss the following?

Overall, the findings suggest a significant imbalance in academic integrity discussions in MTU. Traditional topics like plagiarism and citation receive considerable attention, and, in contrast, emerging challenges such as GenAI tools and data falsification are often neglected, with a majority of respondents indicating limited or no engagement on these topics. This imbalance could result in students being well-prepared for traditional ethical dilemmas while remaining unequipped to address contemporary work and life issues.

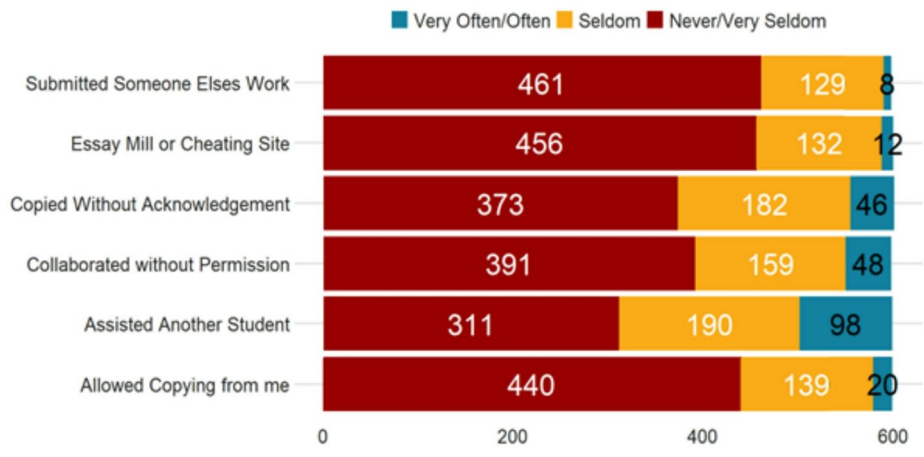
### Self-admission of Misconduct

In terms of the role of reporting tools for misconduct, Fig. 4 (below) reveals self-reported behaviours regarding specific types of academic misconduct, providing insight into areas where intervention may be most needed. The results display clear trends, with some types of misconduct being significantly more common than others.

Submitting someone else's work appears to be the least common behaviour among respondents. A substantial 461 respondents (77% SE 1.7%) reported "Never/Very Seldom" engaging in this, while 129 (22% SE 1.7%) indicated "Seldom," and only 8 (1% SE 0.4%) admitted to doing so "Very Often/Often." Similarly, the use of essay mills or cheating sites also shows low levels of frequent engagement. A significant 456 respondents (76% SE 1.7%) reported "Never/Very Seldom," with 132 (22% SE 1.7%) indicating "Seldom," and just 12 (2% SE 0.6%) admitting frequent use. These results suggest that while these behaviours occur, they remain relatively infrequent compared to other forms of academic dishonesty.

Copying without acknowledgment and collaborating without permission are more prevalent. For instance, 373 respondents (62% SE 2%) reported "Never/Very Seldom" copying without acknowledgment, while 182 (30% SE 1.9%) admitted "Seldom," and 46 (8% SE 1.1%) engaged in it "Very Often/Often." Similarly, 391 respondents (65% SE 2%) claimed they "Never/Very Seldom" collaborated without permission, 159 (26% SE 1.8%) admitted "Seldom," and 48 (8% SE 1.1%) reported doing so frequently. These behaviours highlight a need for greater education on independent work practices and the ethical use of sources.

On the other hand, assisting another student inappropriately shows a higher frequency of occurrence. While 311 respondents (52% SE 2%) reported "Never/Very Seldom," a sig-



**Fig. 4** How often (if ever) have you done the following?

nificant 190 (32% SE 1.9%) admitted “Seldom,” and 98 (16% SE 1.5%) reported doing so “Very Often/Often.” This suggests that many students may not perceive helping peers as seriously unethical, even when it crosses academic boundaries.

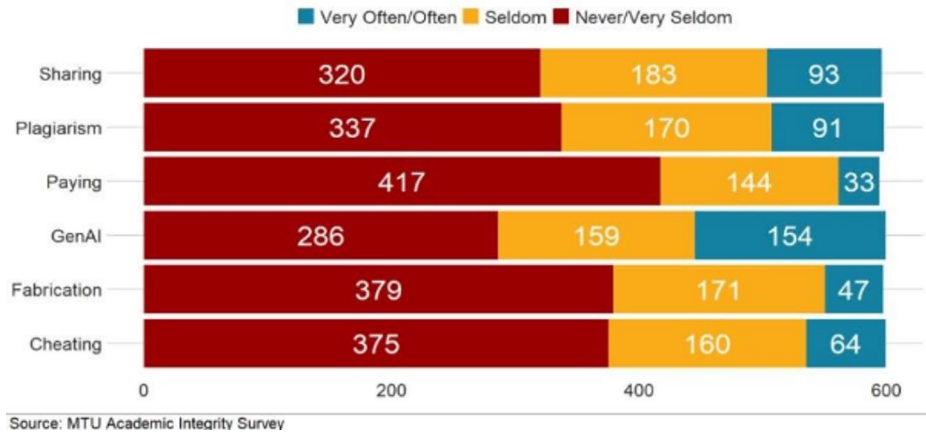
The most frequently admitted behaviour is allowing others to copy from one’s work. A smaller proportion—440 respondents (73% SE 1.8%)—reported “Never/Very Seldom,” while 139 (23% SE 1.7%) admitted “Seldom,” and 20 (3% SE 0.7%) acknowledged frequent engagement. This indicates that students may feel less personal responsibility or ethical conflict when sharing their own work compared to other forms of misconduct.

The data shows that behaviours such as submitting someone else’s work and using essay mills or cheating sites are relatively rare, with the majority of students avoiding these practices entirely. Copying without acknowledgment and collaborating without permission are, as expected, more common, signalling a potential need for clearer guidelines on acceptable collaboration and citation practices. Notably, assisting others inappropriately and allowing copying are even more frequently reported, indicating that students may struggle to understand the ethical boundaries of helping peers.

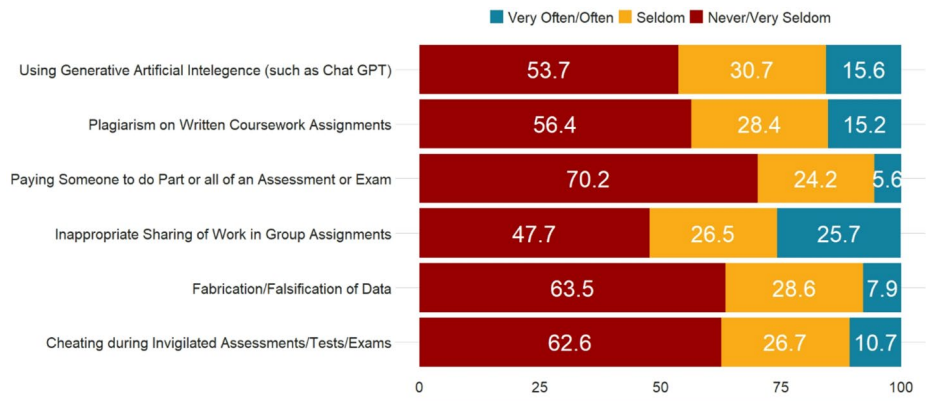
While the overall proportion of students admitting to frequent use of essay mills or cheating sites is relatively low, the potential scale of the issue at MTU is deeply concerning when applied to the university’s student population of approximately 18,000 students. According to the survey, 2% (SE 0.6%) of respondents reported using essay mills “Very Often/Often,” which extrapolating would give an estimate of approximately 360 students across the university engaging in this form of academic misconduct. (Note: this calculation is extending the survey data to the full population of students and should be considered in the context of non response bias from certain groups) Additionally, 22% (SE 1.7%) of respondents admitted to using essay mills “Seldom,” meaning there is potentially between one and two thousand students may occasionally resort to outsourcing their academic work in the Faculties of Business and Humanities and Science and Engineering at Cork Campuses. These figures underscore the significant implications of even small percentages when applied to a large institution. Moreover, the occasional users highlight the broader issue of students potentially turning to these services under stress or due to inadequate academic support. These occasional instances, if left unchecked, could escalate into more widespread reliance on unethical practices.

## Observing Academic Misconduct in Peers

When considering the value of reporting tools (in line with the third research question), one must consider the likelihood such a tool will be used. This value is derived from the likelihood of a breach of academic integrity. The data below in Figs. 5 and 6 highlights the extent to which students observe various forms of academic misconduct among their peers. The numbers are sufficiently high to potentially justify such a tool. Sharing academic materials is one of the least frequently observed behaviours, with only 93 respondents (15.6% SE 1.5%) reporting they witnessed it “Very Often/Often.” A larger 183 respondents (30% SE 1.9%) indicated “Seldom,” while the majority, 320 respondents (52% SE 2%), reported “Never/Very Seldom.” Similarly, plagiarism is observed somewhat often, with 91 respondents (14% SE 1.4%) indicating they saw it “Very Often/Often,” 170 (28% SE 1.8%) reporting “Seldom,” and 337 (55% SE 2.0%) saying they “Never/Very Seldom” observed it.



**Fig. 5** How often (if ever) have you witnessed another student do one of the following?



**Fig. 6** How often (if ever) have you witnessed another student do one of the following?

In contrast, paying for academic work is rarely observed among peers. Only 33 respondents (5% SE 0.9%) reported witnessing it “Very Often/Often,” while 144 (24% SE 1.7%) indicated “Seldom,” and the vast majority, 417 respondents (68% SE 1.9%), said they “Never/Very Seldom” observed this behaviour. This suggests that while paying for academic work occurs, it is not widely visible to students.

Cheating and fabrication or falsification of data are observed by students with greater frequency.

Cheating in an exam was witnessed “Very Often/Often” by 64 respondents (10% SE 1.2%), while 160 (26% SE 1.8%) said “Seldom,” and 375 (61% SE 2%) reported “Never/Very Seldom.” Similarly, fabrication or falsification of data was observed “Very Often/Often” by 47 respondents (8% SE 1.6%), “Seldom” by 171 (28% SE 1.8%), and “Never/Very Seldom” by 379 (62% SE 2%). These findings suggest that while such behaviours exist, they are less visible to most students.

The use of GenAI tools, such as ChatGPT, for misconduct is observed somewhat more frequently. A notable 154154 respondents (15.6% SE 1.5%) indicated seeing this “Very Often/Often,” 159 (30.7% SE 1.9%) noted it “Seldom,” and 286 (53.7% SE 2%) reported “Never/Very Seldom.” This indicates that AI-related misconduct is becoming noticeable, although it is not as widespread as more traditional forms of academic dishonesty.

## GenAI – Comparison by Stage

A significant portion of the survey data suggests that many students view the use of GenAI to complete assignments as cheating. Specifically, (see Fig. 7) 16% (SE 1.5%) of students “Strongly agree” and 27.9% (SE 1.8%) “Agree” with this sentiment, cumulatively representing that almost half of students view such GenAI assistance with scepticism. One in four students think that GenAI should be prohibited in educational settings. On the other hand, almost a third of students think that GenAI can make them a better learner.

Regarding GenAI’s role in enhancing student efficacy, 22.1% (SE 1.7%) of respondents “Agree” and another 10.2% (SE 1.2%) “Strongly Agree” that GenAI makes them more effective learners. This indicates that a substantial number of students find value in GenAI for improving their learning processes, highlighting its perceived benefits in educational productivity.

The distribution of responses regarding whether using GenAI for assignments constitutes cheating shows considerable diversity. While some students agree or strongly agree that it is cheating, many disagree or remain neutral. This reflects a lack of consensus and possible uncertainty about ethical guidelines, indicating a need for clear and consistent messaging from institutions on what constitutes appropriate use.

But, perhaps more importantly, Fig. 8 shows that neutral responses dominate across all four questions or statements, possibly indicating a general tendency towards ambivalence or lack of strong opinions on the topics surveyed. While responses of agreement and disagreement vary, they generally fall in the middle range, showing a division among respondents in terms of agreeing or disagreeing with the statements. Strong opinions are less common and, overall, respondents display a generally neutral or moderate stance, with fewer expressing strong opinions either positively or negatively.

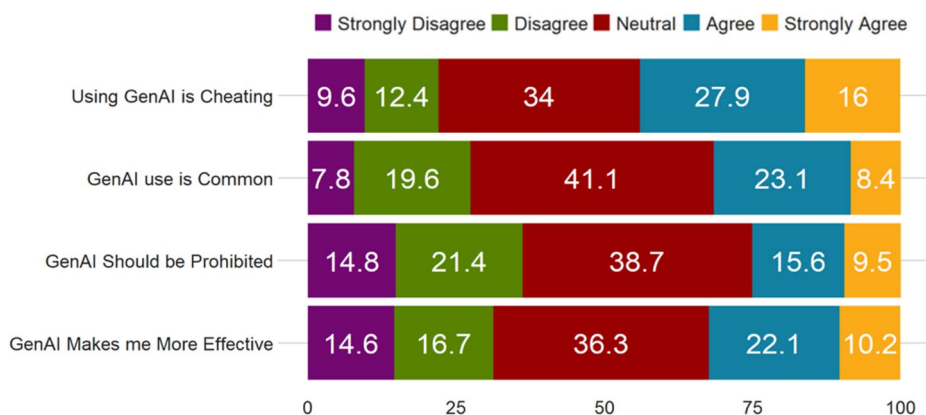
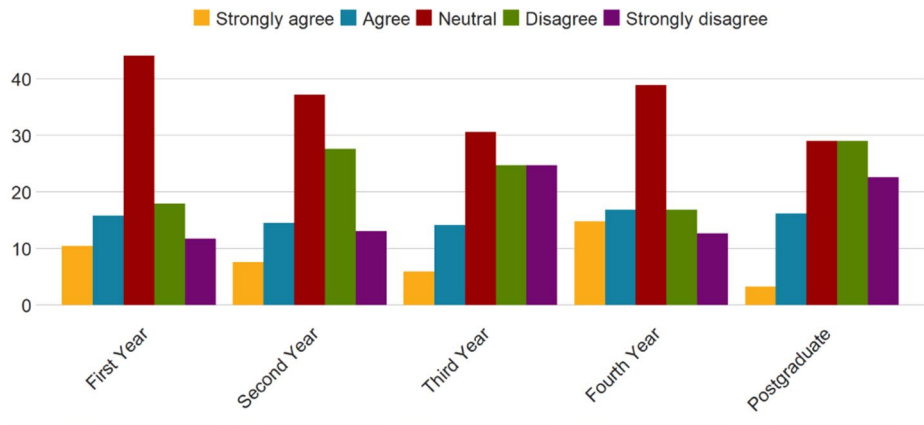


Fig. 7 GenAI -Students’ perceptions



**Fig. 8** Should GenAI be prohibited in educational settings?

In order to improve our understanding of student concerns with GenAI and how it is evolving, we next examined the stage implications on the same questions.

### The Prohibition of GenAI in Educational Settings

Opinions on whether GenAI should be prohibited in educational settings are also mixed, reflecting the community's division. Here, 15.6% (SE 1.5%) “Agree” and 9.5% (SE 1.2%) “Strongly Agree” that it should be banned, suggesting a nontrivial minority, are concerned about the potential negative implications of GenAI in learning environments.

First-year students demonstrated a strong support for prohibiting the use of GenAI, with a notable proportion *strongly agreeing* that its use constitutes a threat to academic integrity. This trend may reflect their limited exposure to GenAI tools and a greater reliance on traditional understandings of academic honesty. As students' progress through their studies, opposition to GenAI decreases, with higher proportions of second-year, third-year and postgraduate students expressing *neutral* or *disagreeing* views. This shift suggests a growing familiarity with AI tools, a more nuanced understanding of their applications, and potentially greater confidence in managing ethical challenges surrounding AI use.

Postgraduate students, while divided in opinion, tend to see GenAI as a tool for enhancing learning efficacy rather than as a threat. This group may benefit from their deeper engagement with research and advanced assessments, which often require critical evaluation and integration of innovative technologies. These findings highlight the need for stage-specific approaches to addressing GenAI in education. First-year students may require more foundational guidance on academic integrity and ethical GenAI use, while postgraduate cohorts may benefit from structured frameworks that promote responsible and productive integration of GenAI into their learning and research practices.

The shift from ambivalence to more defined views among students across academic stages may reflect growing ethical and academic maturity. Postgraduate students, in particular, tend to engage more critically with concepts like authorship, originality, and responsible tool use — not only because of greater institutional interaction, but due to accumulated experience in managing complex assessments and navigating academic norms. This sug-

gests that moral education — including implicit learning through feedback, peer discourse, and mentor interactions — is an invaluable component of student development. Rather than treating ethical clarity as something imposed externally, institutions may benefit from recognising and supporting the internal moral reasoning processes that evolve as students progress.

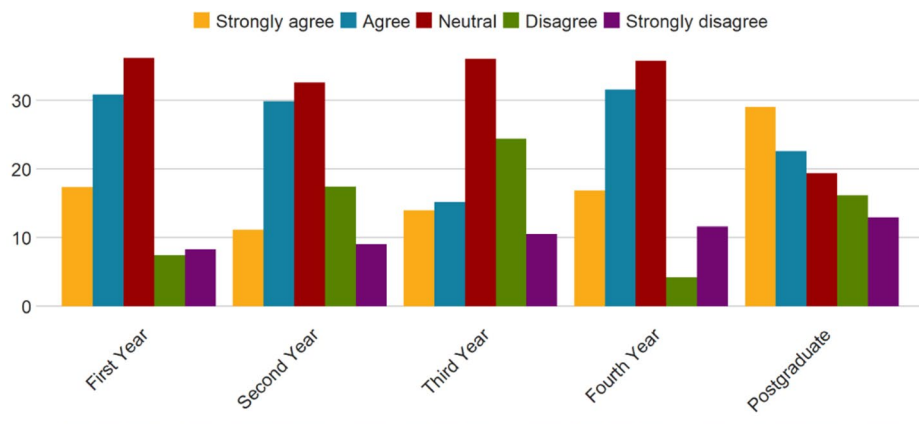
### Using GenAI to Complete Assignments is Cheating

From Fig. 9 we can see that while a significant portion of respondents agree or strongly agree with the statement, there is also a notable group that either disagrees or is neutral. Indeed it is interesting in the context of the previous question, where most students did not agree that it should be prohibited, here we find that most students believe that using GenAI is cheating.

If we look at the stages, there is a notable level of agreement (“Agree” and “Strongly Agree”) across all stages, with first-year and fourth-year students showing relatively similar agreement levels around 30–31%. This suggests that the perception that using GenAI is a form of cheating is somewhat consistent, though it may reflect varying reasons, such as academic experience, exposure to integrity policies, or course-specific guidance. It is worth noting that in all cases for undergraduates the modal class is neutral and that the proportion that “Disagree” and “Strongly Disagree” is less than the “Agree” and “Strongly Agree” in all groups bar third years. This also can reflect a recognition of potential ethical issues associated with the use of GenAI in assessment. This agreement underscores that, despite the presence of nuanced perspectives, a significant number of students are concerned about the implications of unregulated GenAI usage.

### The Use of GenAI is Common Among My Peers

Our expectation was that the newer students would be more familiar with GenAI and it would be less common for the later stages. The contrary was borne out in the data, as shown in Fig. 10, it was determined that first year students had the smallest proportion stating that it was commonly used amongst their peers. Postgraduates had the highest agreement, which



**Fig. 9** Using GenAI to complete assignments is cheating

as previously mentioned indicates the benefit of GenAI tools for more complex topics. This may also have been impacted by the higher proportion of non-native English speakers in the postgraduate category, where nearly 50% of postgraduate responders were non-native speakers. GenAI tools are particularly common tools for correcting/improving language issues in existing content, as opposed to being used for generating novel content.

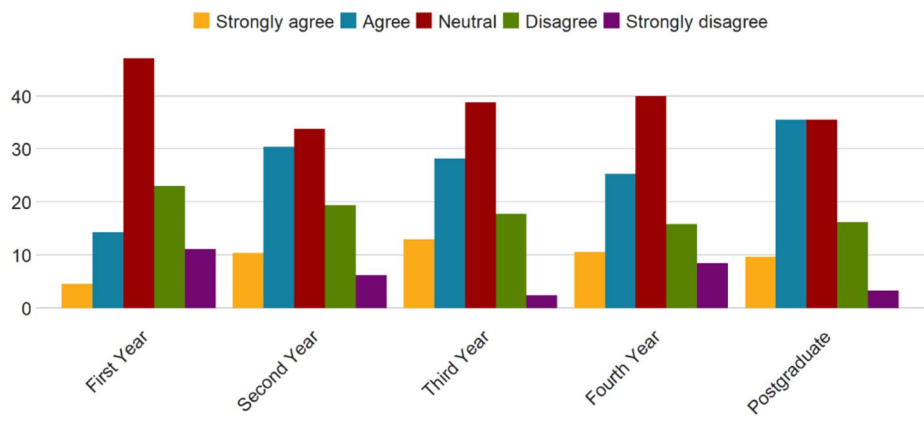
### GenAI Improves Learning

Once again there is a significant portion of “Neutral” responses across different stages, particularly among first-year, second-year, and fourth-year students. This suggests that many students are either unsure of the impact of GenAI on their learning or have had mixed experiences that leave them undecided. This could indicate a need for more structured use or awareness of how to maximise the benefits of GenAI for learning. More advanced students demonstrate a broader spread of responses, from strong agreement to strong disagreement (Fig. 11).

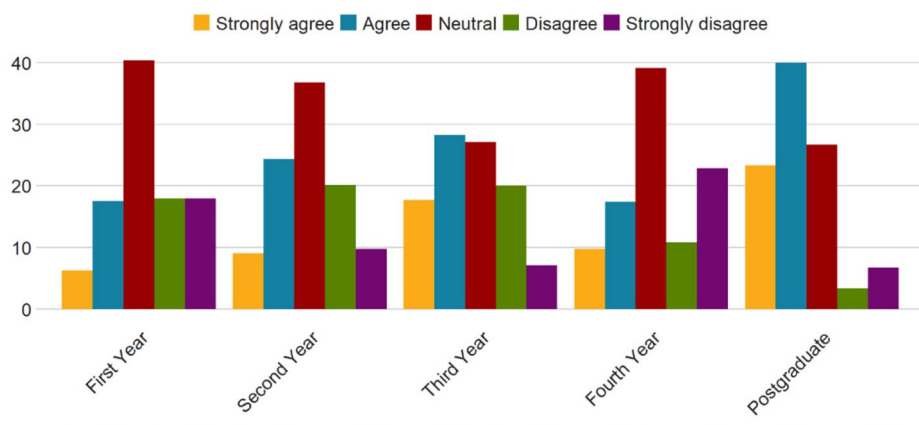
## Discussion

The emergence of GenAI tools such as ChatGPT introduces complex ethical dilemmas that challenge traditional academic integrity frameworks. Central to codes of conduct such as Ireland’s National Principles and Lexicon of Common Terms (2021) are concepts of originality, authorship, honesty, and accountability. GenAI can undermine these principles by enabling the rapid generation of text and ideas without clear attribution or student-led intellectual labour. This challenges the foundational assumption that academic work reflects the student’s own reasoning and skill, particularly in assessments that were not designed to accommodate AI involvement (Panukhnyk, 2023).

As Eke (2023) notes, GenAI can facilitate learning but also makes it difficult to distinguish between assisted and deceptive authorship. This tension is reflected in our findings, where students’ views were divided not only on the acceptability of using GenAI tools, but also on whether such use constitutes cheating. These ambiguities reveal a broader issue:



**Fig. 10** The use of GenAI is common among my peers



**Fig. 11** GenAI improves my learning

ethical frameworks must evolve to address AI-mediated authorship, especially in grey areas like summarisation or paraphrasing support. Moreover, the uncertainty among students signals the need for pedagogical approaches that extend beyond rule-based enforcement. As Bearman et al. (2024) argue, fostering students' evaluative judgment and ethical discernment is crucial in an age where integrity can no longer be policed solely through detection or prohibition.

The threat to academic integrity is also frequently a topic of discussion in scientific literature (Dawson, 2020; Eke, 2023; Perkins, 2023) and in the media (Times Higher Education, 2024). The findings from this study highlight the evolving challenges and opportunities posed by GenAI in higher education, specifically regarding its impact on academic integrity. This work presents the results of a survey and statistical analysis thereof. The results align with existing literature that underscores the dual nature of GenAI as both an educational tool and a potential enabler of misconduct, such as (Hsu, 2025; Lund & Naheem, 2024; Xu et al., 2024). The anonymous nature of the survey has meant that many learners have admitted to academic dishonesty. Nevertheless, it is conceivable that this is underestimated as many participants may not be inclined to admit to such an activity. With the growth of GenAI in recent years, as outlined in the Open Innovation Team and Department for Education (2024), it is likely that the use of such tools will become stronger and more frequent among learners meaning that instructor vigilance must be maintained.

When asked if clear guidelines have been given on the responsible use of AI, significant portions of respondents did not agree. This is much lower for fourth year students and again lower for postgraduate students, which may be attributable to the fact that postgraduate students and fourth year students are undertaking a final year project or major dissertation and as such these topics are likely to be discussed frequently. Perhaps there is a lesson in this that greater emphasis should be placed on referencing from the early stages where new learners are introduced to the university.

It is encouraging to see that there is a critical mass of learners who support the development of an academic dishonesty reporting tool. Even though only a relatively small number of students, approximately one-eighth of those surveyed, indicated that they would report another student for cheating; a majority are in favour of a tool being in place to facilitate

such reporting. It may be the case that learners are not as inclined to report a student themselves but are not against seeing those breaching the rules being reported by others.

The conducted survey revealed a significant gap in students' awareness of institutional academic integrity policies, with only 43% of respondents indicating familiarity. This echoes findings in previous research, which highlight the critical role of faculty in educating students on ethical guidelines (Hill & Hargis, 2025). Lecturers were the most cited source of information, suggesting an opportunity to leverage their influence through structured integrity training. However, the inconsistency in student knowledge also indicates a need for more centralized, accessible resources, such as enhanced digital platforms and collaboration with student unions, which is consistent with other studies (Qureshi, 2024).

There is a slight contradiction between learners' answers on if they have been informed of the policies and where they have learned of academic integrity. In response to "Where did you learn about academic integrity policies," 309 learners listed the source(s) of their academic integrity learning. However, only 263 said they were familiar with the policies. This would indicate that there may be further consideration required in terms of determining and improving the knowledge of learners in this area. One potential approach is outlined by Madray (2007) which proposes classroom-based exercises to improve learners' understanding of academic integrity.

The results also revealed statistically significant differences between faculties on GenAI. Business and Humanities learners used GenAI more frequently than their counterparts in Engineering and Science. This may reflect varying levels of exposure to technology across disciplines, reinforcing the need for discipline-specific approaches to teaching academic integrity. This is particularly noteworthy as the engineering and science faculty would include students in data science and computer science, etc. who are studying fields that contribute to the development of GenAI. A visual inspection of Fig. 5 shows that for plagiarism, falsification and citation, there is little difference present across faculties, as also found by (Qureshi, 2024).

When respondents considered the statement "the use of GenAI was common among my peers", over 70% responded neutral, agreeing, or strongly agreeing. The responses are relatively similar across years where the modal group is either neutral or agree for all years. The postgraduate distribution is bimodal where agree and neutral are equally likely. It may be the case that postgraduates have been reported as having "heightened awareness" of ChatGPT's limitations in an academic setting and expressed more concerns around security related to its use.

Students' perceptions of GenAI mirrored global debates about its ethical use. While 43.9% of respondents to the survey agreed that using GenAI for assignments constitutes cheating, others remained ambivalent and 25.1% of respondents are in favour of prohibition. This division highlights a lack of consensus on the appropriate use of GenAI tools, in line with trends observed in other studies (Dhruv et al., 2024; Wiredu et al., 2024). The integration of GenAI into academic workflows requires clear ethical guidelines and pedagogical strategies, such as the PAIGE framework, which emphasizes responsible GenAI use and critical engagement (Shanto et al., 2023).

Institutions must address the gaps in student awareness and perceptions of integrity policies. Transparent guidelines and comprehensive integrity training should be implemented across all faculties to standardise ethical expectations. Furthermore, integrating GenAI lit-

eracy into curricula could empower students to use these tools responsibly while maintaining academic standards, which mirrors the conclusion by Hill and Hargis (2025).

To advance this agenda, universities should encourage faculty development programs that equip educators with strategies to incorporate GenAI ethically into teaching. Additionally, encouraging interdisciplinary collaboration could promote innovative approaches to leveraging GenAI's potential without compromising academic integrity, as also found by Lund and Naheem (2024).

Examining the responses of students at different stages of their learning to this statement around cheating, undergraduates were most likely to fall in the neutral group with similar shapes to the distributions across years. Perhaps somewhat contradictorily, postgraduates – who generally disagreed with a prohibition of GenAI – have a large proportion of respondents who see it as cheating.

The survey reveals that first-year students largely remain neutral or disagree on GenAI's effectiveness, likely due to limited exposure to these tools early in their academic journey, similar to results reported by Chan and Hu (2023). This is similar to the findings from student surveys conducted by Sousa and Cardoso (2025) that state that substantial proportions of students remain neutral or unconvinced about GenAI. As students progress to second and third years, agreement levels rise, reflecting increased usage of GenAI for tasks like summarisation and brainstorming, although third-year students show a slight uptick in neutral responses, possibly due to adapting to more complex coursework, as also found by Almasaad et al. (2024). Fourth-year students exhibit a notable increase in negative responses, likely tied to the demand for originality and critical thinking in capstone projects and growing concerns about GenAI's role in academic integrity and this was also the case in the study by Saúde et al. (2024). In contrast, postgraduates report the highest agreement levels, leveraging GenAI effectively in research and thesis writing, though a minority remain cautious possibly due to ethical concerns, as also found by Aldossary et al. (2024).

The findings of this survey underline the complexity of integrating GenAI tools into higher education (more results on this survey can be found in Grimes et al. (2024). Students' perceptions vary across academic stages, reflecting diverse levels of exposure, understanding, and confidence in using these tools. First-year students often rely on traditional academic norms and demonstrate scepticism towards GenAI, emphasising the need for foundational training on ethical and productive AI usage, as also found by Kelly et al. (2023). Conversely, postgraduates exhibit higher levels of regarding GenAI's utility, leveraging these tools for advanced research and academic writing. However, their concerns around ethical risks and academic integrity highlight the importance of clear policies and structured pedagogical guidance – here we are in agreement with Hill and Hargis (2025).

The survey included two open-text questions: "In your view, what more could MTU do to help students to avoid engaging in Academic Misconduct?" and "Do you have any other comments regarding Academic Integrity/Academic Misconduct?" One of the key points in the responses to the first item were around providing specific classes to educate students, both on academic integrity ("Have a compulsory lecture in first year orientation that teaches students how to reference, and also tips on writing in general"), and on the use of AI as a tool "Give classes on how to use it correctly and efficiently as a tool not a means to complete assignments". Regarding the former, students emphasised education of the different aspects of what constitutes academic misconduct, and a number of students believed that university should "outline consequences more often". One student stating "I think MTU should

clearly lay out the consequences that students will have to face if they have participated in Academic Misconduct. By clearly laying out consequences for their actions students might be less inclined to do academic misconduct.”

The question of students’ views on reporting academic misconduct is another interesting one. It has been shown that more students are being caught and reported for cheating, with international and transfer students, particularly males, in high-risk majors, and lower grade point averages, needing preventative education (Bertram Gallant et al., 2015). In this survey it was found that many students would not like the idea of reporting another student for cheating, with less than a third of respondents stating that they would report a student, which is in line with other studies (Bertram Gallant et al., 2015; Waltzer et al., 2022).

Regarding the latter, students emphasised its use as a tool “A lot of students including myself use [ChatGPT] for summarising notes and simplifying difficult to comprehend concepts, not to copy and paste assignments. There needs to be some acknowledgment that not all ai [sic] is bad and it doesn’t always equal plagiarism, as technology and facilities advance so should teaching.”

## Limitations and Future Research

While this study offers valuable insights into student perceptions of academic integrity and the use of GenAI at MTU, a few limitations must be acknowledged. As it is often the case, the study is based on self-reported data, which may be affected by social desirability bias—students might underreport misconduct or overstate their awareness of integrity policies. Also, as the study is cross-sectional, it reflects a snapshot in time and does not capture how student perceptions of GenAI and academic integrity evolve over time or in response to changing institutional policies.

Another possible limitation is the response time. While the average response time is approximately 7.2 min, some students spent less than five minutes of the survey.

While this may reflect the clarity and brevity of the instrument, it also raises the possibility that some students engaged only superficially with the questions. Rapid completion increases the risk of satisfying behaviours, such as defaulting to neutral responses or providing minimal engagement with open-text questions. This may partly explain the high proportion of neutral answers observed in some items. Future studies could consider strategies such as attention checks, question randomisation, or more detailed instruments to encourage deeper engagement.

Another key limitation of this study lies in the restricted survey sample, which prevents generalisation of findings to the entire university population. Although over 600 students participated, responses were heavily concentrated within two faculties—Business and Humanities (FBH) and Engineering and Science (FES). As a result, while the data offers valuable insights into the perceptions of students within these specific contexts, it cannot be assumed to reflect the views of the broader student body. For these and other reasons, caution must be exercised when interpreting the results or applying them to institutional policy decisions intended for the entire student population.

Given these limitations, future research could consider a longitudinal approach to track how student attitudes toward academic integrity and GenAI develop over time. The authors intend to re-survey students in MTU in Semester 1, 2025/2026 and are interested in changes in responses around the use of GenAI in the course of their everyday study. The authors

also hope to expand the study across multiple institutions to ensure a more diverse student population.

In-depth qualitative studies, such as interviews or focus groups, could offer richer insights into students' ethical reasoning and decision-making processes. Finally, future work could explore the effectiveness of specific interventions—such as integrity training, AI literacy programs, or reporting tools—in promoting ethical academic behaviour in the era of GenAI.

## Conclusion

This study highlights the relationship between students and academic integrity in the context of Generative AI (GenAI) at MTU. Drawing on responses from 608 students, it reveals that while GenAI holds potential to enhance learning, it simultaneously challenges traditional ethical frameworks. Only 43% of respondents reported being familiar with institutional academic integrity policies, underscoring a significant gap in awareness. At the same time, attitudes toward GenAI remain divided with 43.9% of students believe using it for assignments constitutes cheating, yet over 30% were neutral, suggesting widespread uncertainty.

Despite this ambiguity, student support for accountability measures is clear: 58% expressed a preference for a formal reporting tool, even though only 28% stated they would report a peer directly. Additionally, academic staff tend to focus more on conventional topics like plagiarism and citation, with 64% of students noting frequent discussions of plagiarism, compared to just 21% for GenAI tools.

These findings emphasise the need for targeted, stage-specific educational interventions and clear institutional policies that not only define acceptable GenAI use but also promote ethical academic practices. As universities navigate this transformative technological shift, fostering GenAI literacy and reinforcing a culture of integrity will be key to balancing innovation with responsibility.

**Supplementary Information** The online version contains supplementary material available at <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10805-025-09689-x>.

**Author Contributions** Conceptualisation, VM, DG and DH; methodology, VM and DG; data analysis, DH; first draft preparation, VM; review and editing, VM, DG and DH.

**Funding** This research was conducted as part of MTU's 'Strategic Alignment of Teaching and Learning Enhancement 2023' (SATLE 2023) funding allocation from the National Forum for the Enhancement of Teaching and Learning in Higher Education (Ireland) in partnership with the Higher Education Authority.

**Data Availability** Data will be made available upon reasonable request from the corresponding author.

## Declarations

**Ethical Approval** The present study operated under approval from MTU's Human Research Ethics Committee (HREC). Approval Number: HREC-MR-23-024-A. All survey participants gave their consent, and participation in the survey was entirely voluntary and anonymous. Participants were free to exit the survey at any stage. No monetary incentives were offered to participants.

**Consent for Publication** All authors (V Morari, D Grimes, D Hawe) give their consent for publication.

**Competing Interests** The authors declare that they have no competing interests.

## References

- Aldossary, A. S., Aljindi, A. A., & Alamri, J. M. (2024). The role of generative AI in education: Perceptions of Saudi students. *Contemporary Educational Technology*, 16(4), Article ep536. <https://doi.org/10.30935/cedtech/15496>
- Almassaad, A., Alajlan, H., & Alebaikan, R. (2024). Student perceptions of generative artificial intelligence: Investigating utilization, benefits, and challenges in higher education. *Systems*, 12(10), Article 385. <https://doi.org/10.3390/systems12100385>
- Amoozadeh, M., Daniels, D., Chen, S., Nam, D., Kumar, A., Hilton, M., & Ragavan, S. S. (2023, August). Towards characterizing trust in generative artificial intelligence among students. In *Proceedings of the 2023 ACM Conference on International Computing Education Research-Volume 2* (pp. 3–4). <https://doi.org/10.1145/3568812.3603469>
- Barros, A., Prasad, A., & Śliwa, M. (2023). Generative artificial intelligence and academia: Implication for research, teaching and service. *Management Learning*, 54(5), 597–604. <https://doi.org/10.1177/13505076231201445>
- Bearman, M., Tai, J., Dawson, P., Boud, D., & Ajjawi, R. (2024). Developing evaluative judgement for a time of generative artificial intelligence. *Assessment & Evaluation in Higher Education*, 49(6), 893–905. <https://doi.org/10.1080/02602938.2024.2335321>
- Bertram Gallant, T., Binkin, N., & Donohue, M. (2015). Students at risk for being reported for cheating. *Journal of Academic Ethics*, 13(3), 217–228. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10805-015-9235-5>
- Bowers, W. J. (1964). *Student dishonesty and its control in college*. Bureau of applied social Research, Columbia university. Student Dishonesty and Its Control in College by William J. Bowers - Books on Google Play.
- Bu, Q. (2022). Ethical risks in integrating artificial intelligence into education and potential countermeasures. *Science Insights*, 41(1), 561–566. <https://doi.org/10.15354/si.22.re067>
- Busch, P., & Bilgin, A. (2014). Student and staff understanding and reaction: Academic integrity in an Australian university. *Journal of Academic Ethics*, 12(3), 227–243. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10805-014-9214-2>
- Campbell, W. G. (1933). Measurement in determining the personality and behavior of the college cribber. *Education*, 53(7), 403–408.
- Chan, C. K. Y., & Hu, W. (2023). Students' voices on generative AI: Perceptions, benefits, and challenges in higher education. *International Journal of Educational Technology in Higher Education*, 20(1), Article 43. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41239-023-00411-8>
- Dawson, P. (2020). *Defending assessment security in a digital world: Preventing e-cheating and supporting academic integrity in higher education*. Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9780429324178>
- Dhruv, A., Saha, S., Tyagi, S., & Jain, V. (2024, May). Investigating the transformative impact of generative AI on academic integrity across diverse educational domains. In *2024 2nd International Conference on Advancement in Computation & Computer Technologies (InCACCT)* (pp. 87–92). IEEE. <https://doi.org/10.1109/InCACCT61598.2024.10551108>
- Economic and Social Impact Study of MTU (2024). <https://www.mtu.ie/media/mtu-website/files/esis/MTU-ESIS-Final-Report.pdf>
- Eke, D. O. (2023). ChatGPT and the rise of generative AI: Threat to academic integrity? *Journal of Responsible Technology*, 13, Article 100060. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jrt.2023.100060>
- Farrelly, T., & Baker, N. (2023). Generative artificial intelligence: Implications and considerations for higher education practice. *Education Sciences*, 13(11), Article 1109. <https://doi.org/10.3390/educsci13111109>
- Freeman, J. (2024). Provide or punish? Students' views on generative AI in higher education. *Higher Education Policy Institute*. HEPI-Policy-Note-51.pdf.
- Freeman, J. (2025). Student generative ai survey 2025. *Higher Education Policy Institute*. HEPI-Policy-Note-61-2.pdf.
- Grimes, D., Hurley, M., Morari, V., & O'Mahony, J. (2024, June). Academic Integrity differences across faculties: A student survey. In *10th International Conference on Higher Education Advances (HEAD'24)*. Editorial Universitat Politècnica de València. <https://doi.org/10.4995/HEAD24.2024.17312>
- Haroud, S., & Saqri, N. (2025). Generative AI in higher education: Teachers' and students' perspectives on support, replacement, and digital literacy. *Education Sciences*, 15(4), Article 396. <https://doi.org/10.3390/educsci15040396>
- Hartshorne, H., May, M. A., & Maller, J. B. (1929). Studies in the nature of character, II Studies in service and self-control. <https://psycnet.apa.org/https://doi.org/10.1037/11334-000>
- Healy, M. (2023). Approaches to generative artificial intelligence, a social justice perspective. *ArXiv Preprint arXiv: 2309.12331*. <https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.24788.78723>
- Hill, C., & Hargis, J. (2025). An ethics module on academic integrity and generative AI. *New Directions for Teaching and Learning*, 2025, 41–50. <https://doi.org/10.1002/tl.20626>

- Hill, P. A., & Narine, L. K. (2023). Ensuring responsible and transparent use of generative AI in extension. *The Journal of Extension*, 61(2), Article 13. <https://doi.org/10.34068/joe.61.02.13>
- Hsu, Y. C. (2025). Ch6: Integrating GenAI into Your Classroom. *Empowering Education: Harnessing the Potential of Generative Artificial Intelligence*. <https://boisestate.pressbooks.pub/GenAIempowereducation>
- Hughes, J. M. C., & McCabe, D. L. (2006). Academic misconduct within higher education in Canada. *Canadian Journal of Higher Education*, 36(2), 1–21. <https://doi.org/10.47678/cjhe.v36i2.183537>
- Johnston, H., Wells, R. F., Shanks, E. M., Boey, T., & Parsons, B. N. (2024). Student perspectives on the use of generative artificial intelligence technologies in higher education. *International Journal for Educational Integrity*, 20(1), Article 2. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40979-024-00149-4>
- Kelly, A., Sullivan, M., & McLaughlan, P. (2023). ChatGPT in higher education: Considerations for academic integrity and student learning. *Journal of Applied Learning and Teaching*, 6(1), 31–40. <https://doi.org/10.37074/jalt.2023.6.1.17>
- Lodge, J., Thompson, K., & Corrin, L. (2023). Mapping out a research agenda for generative artificial intelligence in tertiary education. *Australasian Journal of Educational Technology*, 39(1), 1–8. <https://doi.org/10.14742/ajet.8695>
- Lorenz, P., Perset, K., & Berryhill, J. (2023). *Initial policy considerations for generative artificial intelligence* (No. 1). OECD Publishing. <https://doi.org/10.1787/fae2d1e6-en>
- Lund, B. D., & Naheem, K. T. (2024). Can ChatGPT be an author? A study of artificial intelligence authorship policies in top academic journals. *Learned Publishing*, 37(1), 13–21. <https://doi.org/10.1002/leap.1582>
- Madray, A. (2007). Developing students' awareness of plagiarism: Crisis and opportunities. *Library Philosophy and Practice*, 134. Developing Students' Awareness of Plagiarism: Crisis and Opportunities.
- Malmström, H., Stöhr, C., & Ou, A. W. (2023). Chatbots and other AI for learning: A survey of use and views among university students in Sweden. *Chalmers Studies in Communication and Learning in Higher Education*, 1(10.17196). <https://doi.org/10.17196/cls.cselhe/2023/01>
- McCabe, D. L. (2005). Cheating among college and university students: A North American perspective. *International Journal for Educational Integrity*, 1(1). <https://doi.org/10.21913/IJEI.v1i1.14>
- National Principles and Lexicon of Common Terms (2021). Academic Integrity: National Principles and Lexicon of Common Terms. [academic-integrityacademic-integrity-national-principles-and-lexicon-of-common-terms.pdf](https://academic-integrity.org/academic-integrity-national-principles-and-lexicon-of-common-terms.pdf)
- Newstead, S. E., Franklyn-Stokes, A., & Armstead, P. (1996). Individual differences in student cheating. *Journal Of Educational Psychology*, 88(2), 229. <https://doi.org/10.1037/0022-0663.88.2.229>
- Newton, P. M., & Essex, K. (2024). How common is cheating in online exams and did it increase during the COVID-19 pandemic? A systematic review. *Journal of Academic Ethics*, 22(2), 323–343. <https://doi.org/10.21203/rs.3.rs-2187710/v1>
- Open Innovation Team and Department for Education. (2024). *Generative AI in education: Educator and expert views*. *Generative AI in education*. Educator and expert views.
- Panukhnyk, O. (2023). Policy of academic and research integrity in the conditions of the AI revolution: Formula of interaction. *Galic'kij ekonomičnij visnik*. [https://doi.org/10.33108/galicianvisnyk\\_tntu2023.05.185](https://doi.org/10.33108/galicianvisnyk_tntu2023.05.185)
- Perkins, M. (2023). Academic integrity considerations of AI large Language models in the post-pandemic era: ChatGPT and beyond. *Journal of University Teaching and Learning Practice*, 20(2), 1–24. <https://doi.org/10.53761/1.2.02.07>
- Qadir, J. (2023). Engineering education in the era of ChatGPT: Promise and pitfalls of generative AI for education. In *2023 IEEE global engineering education conference (EDUCON)* (pp. 1–9). IEEE. <https://doi.org/10.1109/EDUCON54358.2023.10125121>
- Qureshi, F. (2024). Redesigning assessments in business education: Addressing generative AI's impact on academic integrity. *International Journal of Science and Research*, 13(10), 1761–1765. <https://doi.org/10.21275/sr241021051659>
- Saúde, S., Barros, J. P., & Almeida, I. (2024). Impacts of generative artificial intelligence in higher education: Research trends and students' perceptions. *Social Sciences*, 13(8), Article 410. <https://doi.org/10.3390/socsci13080410>
- Shanto, S. S., Ahmed, Z., & Jony, A. I. (2023). PAIGE: A generative AI-based framework for promoting assignment integrity in higher education. *Stem Education*, 3(4), 288–305. <https://doi.org/10.3934/steme.2023018>
- Simon, & Sheard, J. (2015, November). In their own words: students and academics write about academic integrity. In *Proceedings of the 15th Koli Calling Conference on Computing Education Research* (pp. 97–106). <https://doi.org/10.1145/2828959.2828977>
- Sousa, A. E., & Cardoso, P. (2025). Use of generative AI by higher education students. *Electronics*, 14(7), Article 1258. <https://doi.org/10.3390/electronics14071258>

- Taiye, M., High, C., Velandar, J., Matar, K., Okmanis, R., & Milrad, M. (2024, April). Generative ai-enhanced academic writing: A stakeholder-centric approach for the design and development of chat4isp-ai. In *Proceedings of the 39th ACM/SIGAPP Symposium on Applied Computing* (pp. 74–80). <https://doi.org/10.1145/3605098.3636055>
- Times Higher Education (2024). *The Challenges Facing Universities to Uphold Academic Integrity*. <https://www.timeshighereducation.com/campus/challenges-facing-universities-uphold-academic-integrity>
- Vartiainen, H., & Tedre, M. (2023). Using artificial intelligence in craft education: Crafting with text-to-image generative models. *Digital Creativity*, 34(1), 1–21. <https://doi.org/10.1080/14626268.2023.2174557>
- Waltzer, T., Samuelson, A., & Dahl, A. (2022). Students' reasoning about whether to report when others cheat: Conflict, confusion, and consequences. *Journal of Academic Ethics*, 20(2), 265–287. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10805-021-09414-4>
- Wiredu, J. K., Abuba, S. N., & Zakaria, H. (2024). Impact of generative AI in academic integrity and learning outcomes: A case study in the upper East region. *Asian Journal of Research in Computer Science*, 17(8), 70–88. <https://doi.org/10.9734/ajrcos/2024/v17i7491>
- Xu, X., Su, Y., Zhang, Y., Wu, Y., & Xu, X. (2024). Understanding learners' perceptions of chatgpt: A thematic analysis of peer interviews among undergraduates and postgraduates in China. *Heliyon*, 10(4), Article e26239. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.heliyon.2024.e26239>
- Yu, H., & Guo, Y. (2023). Generative artificial intelligence empowers educational reform: Current status, issues, and prospects. *Frontiers in Education*, 8, Article 1183162. <https://doi.org/10.3389/educ.2023.1183162>
- Zernike, K. (2002). With student cheating on the rise, more colleges are turning to honor codes. *New York Times*, 2, A10. With Student Cheating on the Rise, More Colleges Are Turning to Honor Codes - The New York Times.
- Teodorescu, D., & Andrei, T. (2009). Faculty and peer influences on academic integrity: College cheating in Romania. *Higher Education*, 57(3), 267–282. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10734-008-9143-3>

**Publisher's Note** Springer Nature remains neutral with regard to jurisdictional claims in published maps and institutional affiliations.

Springer Nature or its licensor (e.g. a society or other partner) holds exclusive rights to this article under a publishing agreement with the author(s) or other rightsholder(s); author self-archiving of the accepted manuscript version of this article is solely governed by the terms of such publishing agreement and applicable law.